

PSP phone

The rumoured Sony PlayStation Phone made its way all around China, revealing all

More from Sony

Ironically, the PSP2 might release before the much leaked PlayStation Phone

Dual core phones, getting smarter by the day

Lots of dual-core powered phones also made their way into the global consciousness at CES, though LG had beaten everyone to the punch with the LG Optimus 2X announcement earlier in December 2010. LG has now expanded its Optimus lineup of smartphones further by introducing the LG Optimus Black, making headlines this time around for its super slim form factor (9.2 mm that diets to 6 mm at its thinnest) and its new NOVA display.

The display is appropriately named, providing a night-sky obliterating 700 nits of brightness on its 4-inch screen. A little contrary to the theme, but no less appreciated, is its claimed 50 per cent better power efficiency, which when coupled with the phone's 1500 mAh battery, apparently gives up to 24 hours of usage. For now, the display's resolution has not been revealed. Designed keeping in mind the smartphone's credo of web browsing, the NOVA display is supposed to consume less than half the power required by AMOLED technology for the white gamut.

Running Froyo (v2.2) with Optimus UI 2.0 on board, the Optimus Black will apparently be eligible for a Gingerbread (v2.3) update somewhere down the line. Other features include an overkill first-of-its-kind front-facing 2MP camera, as well as another smartphone first - Wi-Fi Direct for quick data transfer between mobile devices.

Sony Ericsson is also battling for the crown of the



A quick look at the specifications usually leave some drool on the floor: 4-inch (960x540) Gorilla Glass capacitive touchscreen with qHD rating and 24-bit colour, 1GHz dual core Nvidia Tegra 2 CPU/GPU, 1GB RAM, 16GB internal storage (expandable to 48GB with microSD card), 5MP rear camera capable of 720p HD and front-facing VGA camera for video calls, 2.4GHz and 5GHz Wi-Fi 802.11n support, dual-microphones for active noise cancellation, and a massive 1930 mAh battery. All this madness, squeezed into less than 11mm of thickness.

The first of the phone's transforming docks is the Motorola HD Multimedia Dock, which gives users the flexibility of docking their phones with three USB ports and one HDMI, perfect for connecting it up to a TV, keyboard, mouse, speakers, all at the same time. The second, Motorola Laptop Dock, is probably the more revolutionary of the two, and perhaps what makes the Motorola Atrix's form factor totally ridiculous...the dock is basically an ultralight and ultrathin laptop without a CPU. It has an 11.6-inch screen, and a full-sized keyboard, along with stereo speakers, and a 36Wh three-cell battery which is rated to deliver up to eight hours of battery life. Total weight, including phone, is approximately 1kg. Those who've had their hands on have gone away giddy with excitement, claiming superlative response times with no perceptible lag, as well as a great environment for web-browsing. 



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world's slimmest phone, with its latest offering Sony Ericsson Xperia arc apparently just 8.7mm thick at its thinnest. Featuring an extra wide capacitive (with multi-touch) touchscreen, the Xperia arc touts Sony Ericsson's new 4.2-inch Reality Display, which boasts of a Mobile Bravia Engine for optimal viewing pleasure. Other features include a 1GHz Snapdragon processor, and an 8.1MP camera that's powered by Sony's Exmor R sensor (apparently great for low-light coupled with the phone's f/2.4

lens) and capable of 720p HD video recording as well.

Possibly the star of the show, the Motorola Atrix 4G is a device that has captured the imagination of a horde of technophiles with its capability and versatility. Certainly not lacking in innovation, it currently runs Froyo, but will get an upgrade to Gingerbread possibly even before launch. 'Just' a phone, the Atrix 4G is supremely well-endowed, and, comes with exciting accessories such as docks that convert the phone into something more.